Copilot: choose the right AI assistant for the job

Audience: Executive decision-makers
Decision: Choose by job; verify access, licensing, grounding, and output scope.

Executive Summary

Bottom line: Copilot is a family, not one tool; choose Chat, Microsoft 365, GitHub, or Studio by job, then verify access, licensing, and grounding.

Narration

Bottom line: Copilot is a family, not one tool; choose Chat, Microsoft 365, GitHub, or Studio by job, then verify access, licensing, and grounding.

Copilot Chat fits research and drafting. It can summarize web information, rewrite content, analyze files, create images, use agents, and ask supported work questions.

Microsoft 365 Copilot brings AI into work apps. Grounding, user permissions, compliance controls and license level shape what it can answer for each person.

GitHub Copilot fits coding workflows in developer tools. Copilot Studio builds agents and workflows connected to organizational data, systems, and channels for teams.

Make the decision after the fit is clear. Check permissions, license tier, and grounding so leaders know what each output can and cannot use in practice.

1. 1. Choose by job

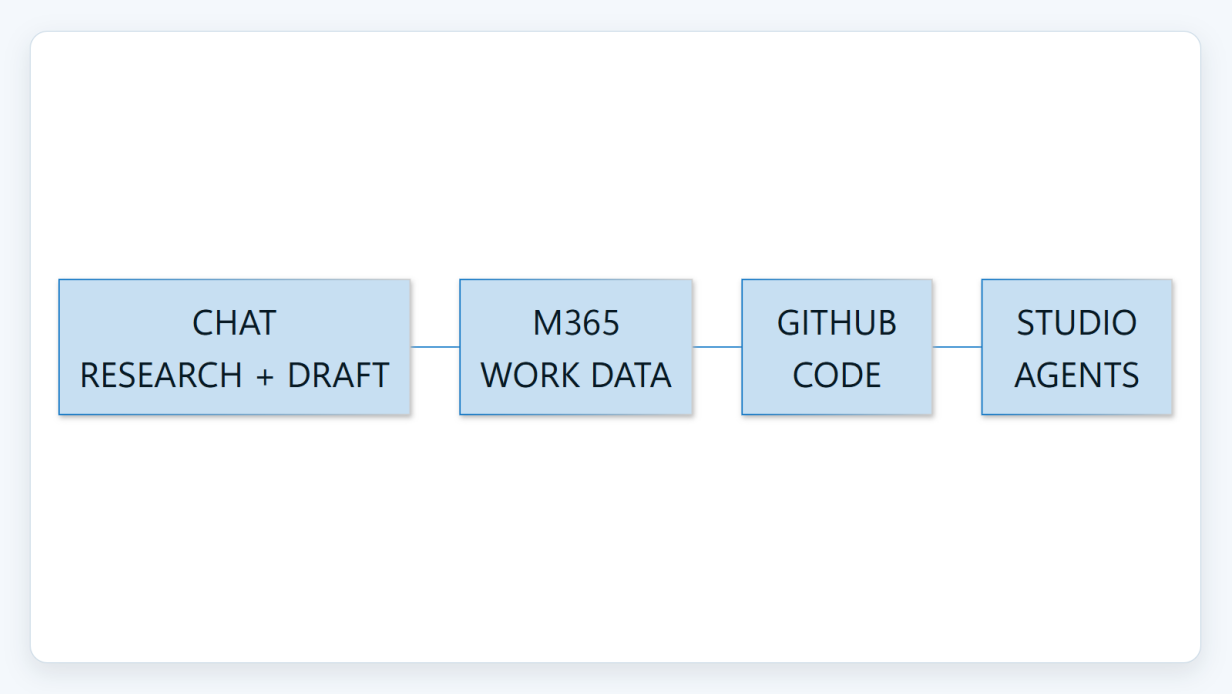
Copilot Chat fits research and drafting. It can summarize web information, rewrite content, analyze files, create images, use agents, and ask supported work questions.

Claims

- Copilot Chat supports research, content generation, file analysis, images, agents, and supported organizational questions.
- The executive choice is job first, then access, licensing, grounding, and output scope.

Assets and alt text

- visual-choose-by-job: Route Copilot choices by the job the leader needs done. (mermaid diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: ev-01 lists Copilot Chat research, generation, file analysis, images, agents, and supported organizational questions. Interpretation: make the task the first routing filter.

2. 2. Govern access

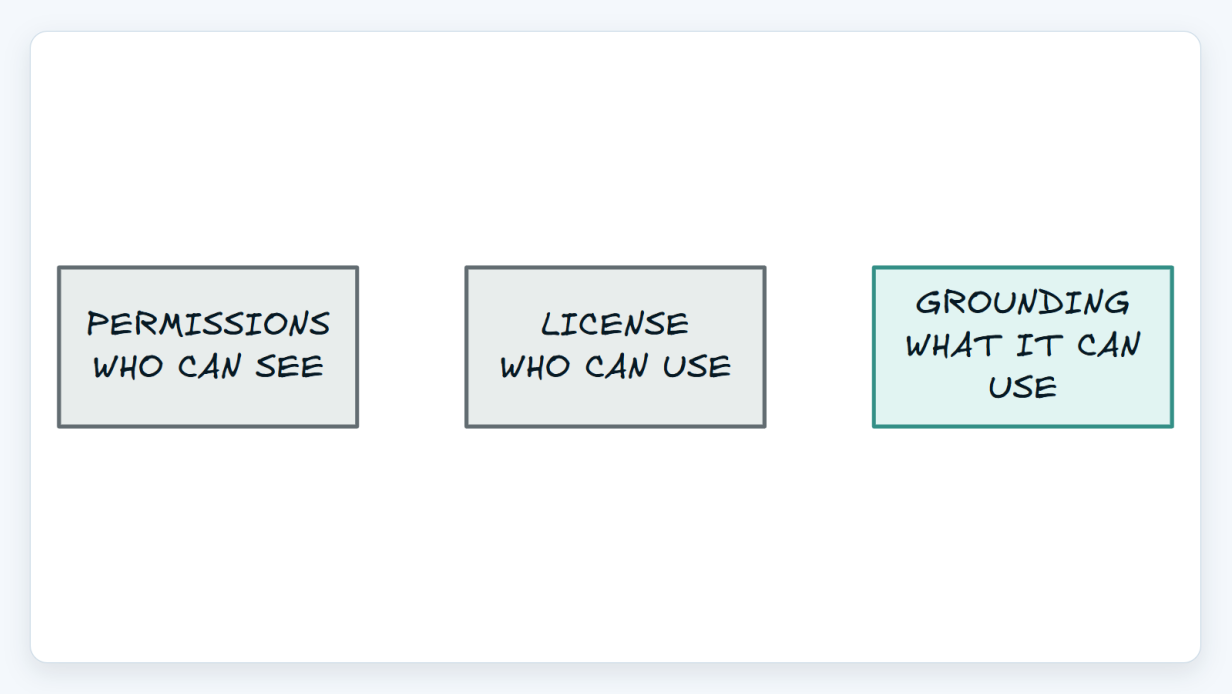
Microsoft 365 Copilot brings AI into work apps. Grounding, user permissions, compliance controls and license level shape what it can answer for each person.

Claims

- Microsoft 365 Copilot is shaped by organizational grounding, user permissions, compliance controls, work-app access, and license level.
- The executive choice is job first, then access, licensing, grounding, and output scope.

Assets and alt text

- visual-govern-access: Access governance makes the permitted information boundary explicit. (excalidraw diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: ev-03 documents grounding, organizational data, user permissions, and compliance; ev-04 ties the full work-app experience to the Microsoft 365 Copilot add-on license.

3. 3. Separate builders

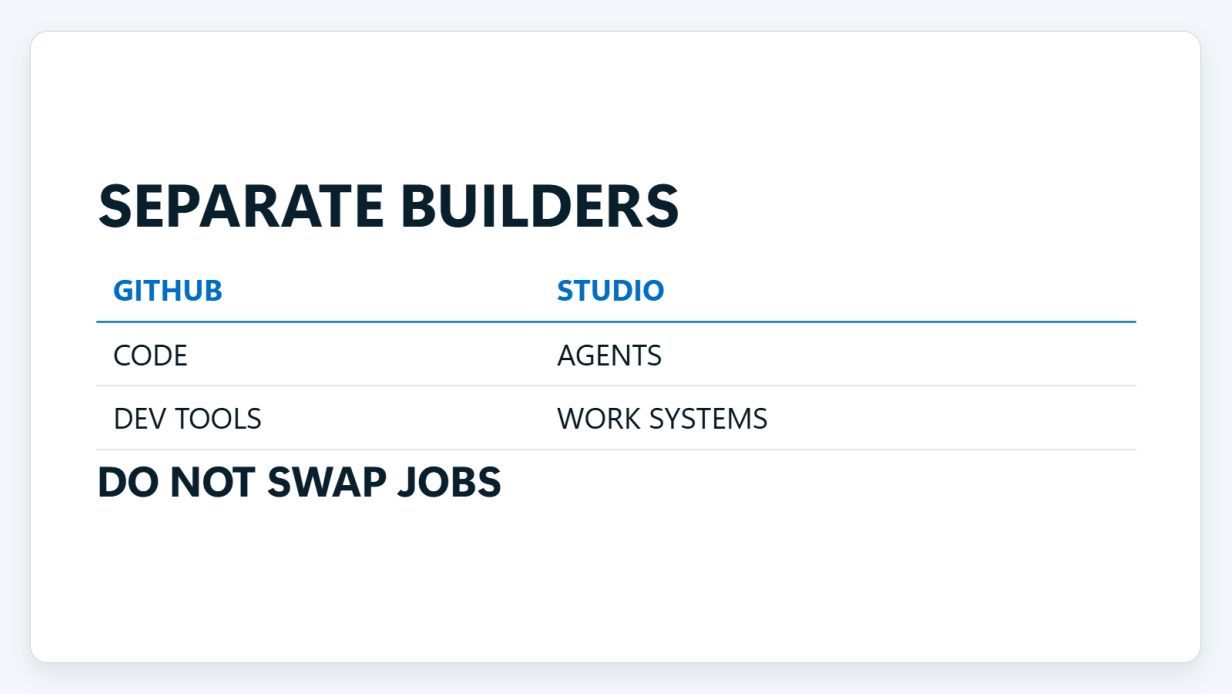
GitHub Copilot fits coding workflows in developer tools. Copilot Studio builds agents and workflows connected to organizational data, systems, and channels for teams.

Claims

- GitHub Copilot supports coding work in editors, the command line, and GitHub, including completing code, edits, validation, and workflow support.
- Copilot Studio is a low-code route for building agents and workflows connected to organizational data, systems, and channels.

Assets and alt text

- visual-builder-routes: Coding assistance and business-agent building are different routes. (marp diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: ev-05 and ev-06 place GitHub Copilot in coding surfaces; ev-07 and ev-08 define Copilot Studio as a low-code agent and workflow builder connected to organizational systems.

4. 4. Run decision checks

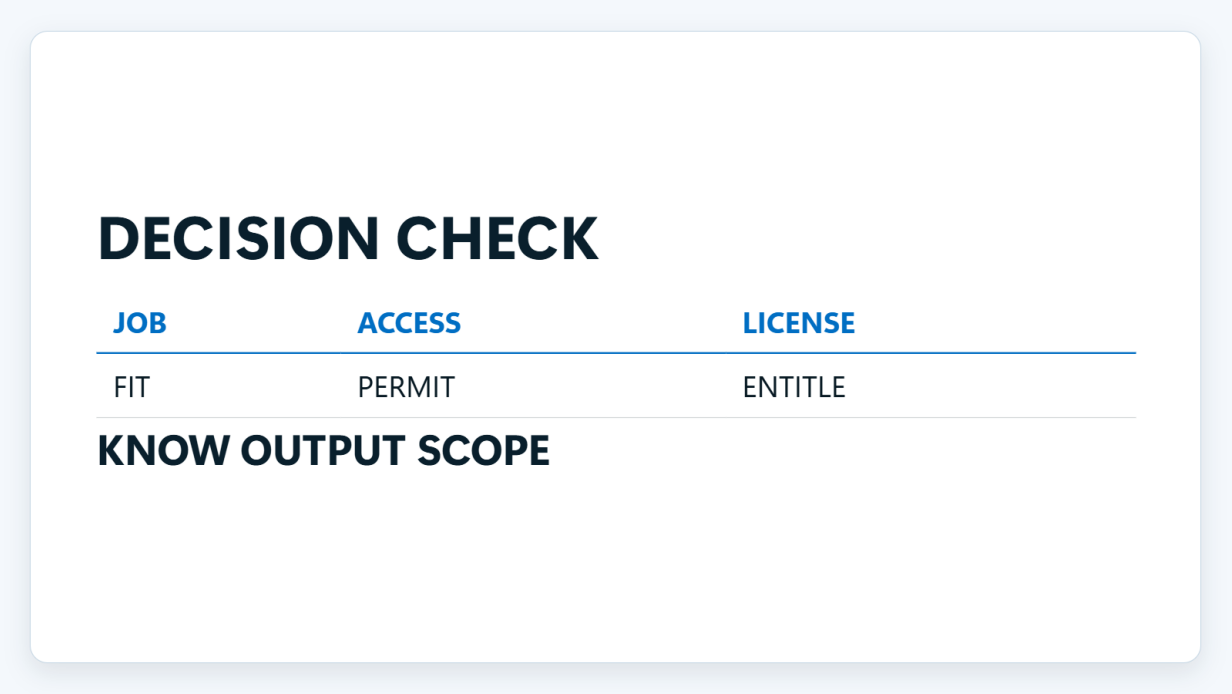
Make the decision after the fit is clear. Check permissions, license tier, and grounding so leaders know what each output can and cannot use in practice.

Claims

- Microsoft 365 Copilot is shaped by organizational grounding, user permissions, compliance controls, work-app access, and license level.
- The executive choice is job first, then access, licensing, grounding, and output scope.

Assets and alt text

• visual-decision-checks: The final executive gate checks fit, access, licensing and grounding. (marp diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: ev-02 and ev-03 show available information depends on access point, license, grounding, and permissions. Interpretation: output scope should be part of the executive decision gate.

Citations

[ev-01, ev-02] Overview of Microsoft Copilot Chat
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/overview retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:25.109Z
[ev-03, ev-04] What is Microsoft Copilot?
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/microsoft-365/microsoft-365-copilot-overview retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:25.380Z
[ev-05, ev-06] GitHub Copilot · Your AI coding agent · GitHub
https://github.com/features/copilot retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:25.831Z
[ev-07, ev-08] Overview - Microsoft Copilot Studio
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/fundamentals-what-is-copilot-studio retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:25.952Z